



MicroTik The Dude

The Dude watches All

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Monitoring networks is required to be done in organisations of all sizes from time to time. A network monitoring utility can also be used by an ISP to pinpoint problems with the network or possible troublemakers. We look at Wireshark and in this 30 minutes expert section, we're looking at MicroTik. Like Wireshark, it too is free and is available for download at www.mikrotik.com/thedude.php.

Mapping Your Network

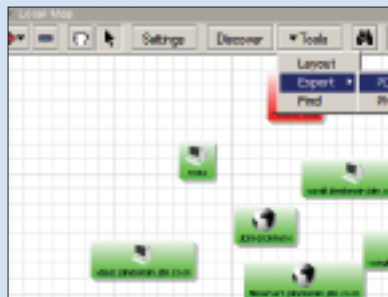
Discovering the network means the structure of the entire network is scanned and a representation of it is displayed on the screen. When you first run The Dude after installing, the first prompt requires you to confirm discovering of the network. To look at the map of the network at any given moment, double click on the Local Map item under Network Maps.

Manually Mapping The Network

If you think that the automatic mapping feature doesn't map your network as you'd like it, you can create your own mapping. You can do this by creating devices and links between them using the Add button on the toolbar. Custom background images can be used which can be particularly useful for ISPs mapping their network of customers. A map or a Google Maps snapshot can make things much simpler.

Exporting Maps

For many, just the ability of The Dude to be able to generate a map of the



Network maps can be exported to formats such as PDF and PNG

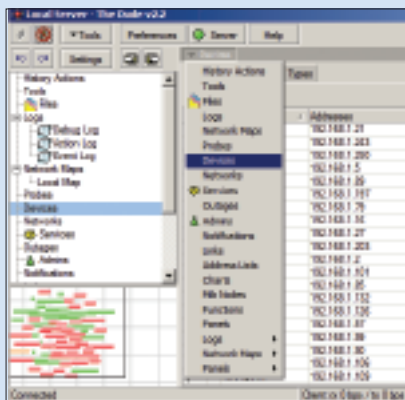
network might be special. The software can be used to export the scanned network structure into an image or a PDF file. Click on the window with the network map on it. Click on Tools > Export > PDF or PNG to export the structure.

Filtering Devices List

If your network has many machines on it and you are looking for PCs of a particular kind, say a web server or mail servers, it can be painful sorting and browsing through the endless list. To see the entire list of devices, click on the Devices item on the left pane. On the right top of the panel, you will find dropdown menus for the status and type of device. Set the conditions and the list will be filtered as per your requirements.

Quickly Changing Window Components

All of the features of The Dude appear in panels windows within the primary window. The various modules of the program can be put into any of the panels by clicking on the dropdown menu on the left top of the panel. Modules can also be

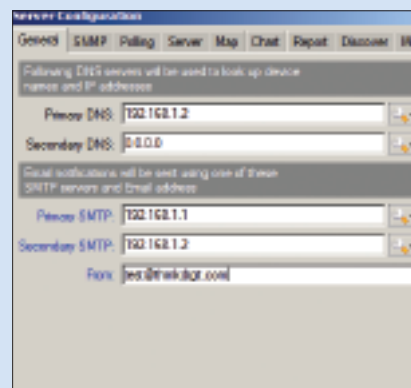


Functions of each of the panels can be changed

dragged and dropped into any of the other panels. A similar list is available for devices and the services running on them which can be found in the Services item.

Getting Notified Of Events

Events in The Dude can be sent to the



KMPlayer has all the necessary features for being a dedicated audio player

administrator using e-mail and some other methods. E-Mail is one of the simpler things to set up. Click on the Settings button on the interface. The General tab has a section for E-mail notifications. Enter the primary and secondary SMTP servers that you want to use and an e-mail address for the software itself. Click OK.

Another way to communicate with the application is to use the web interface feature. First open up the Settings window by clicking on the button. It can be enabled by navigating to the Server tab and then on the Web Access section. Click on the Enable checkbox and then click OK.

Outage Monitoring

The Dude has a feature called Outages which monitor which services and PCs go offline and at what time. Click on the item on the left panel to view the details. Filters are available to sort out the devices and the current status. The status of the machines is updated across all the maps and lists simultaneously.

Backing Up And Restoring Settings

All the settings in The Dude can be saved for use at a later time if any issues or confusion arises. When you are pleased with the way The Dude has been set up, click on the Export button on the toolbar on top. Enter a name for the file and save it. Similarly, importing of the settings file can be done by clicking the Import button. ■

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Change Message Priority

You can set priority of your outgoing message to convey its importance. Three levels of priorities are available—Low, normal and high. Here's how you set the priority.

1. In the message composition window menu, go to Options>Priority.
2. Select the priority you want to assign to your message.

Check For New Mail And Set Periodical Checks

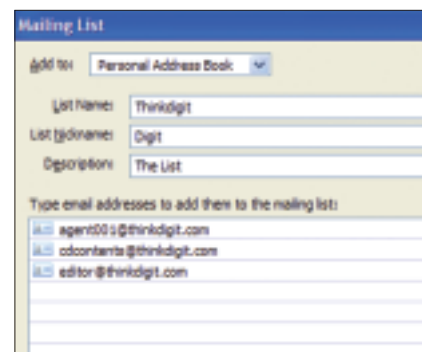
Though Thunderbird has nice big buttons to Get/Send mails it's better to learn the key combination which lets you do it quickly. If your e-mail traffic is high then it's better to automate the checking process.

1. For checking new mail quickly, just press [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [T] and client will automatically connect and pop your mails from the server.
2. To check mails periodically, go to Tools > Account settings.
3. Go to the Server Settings sub-category of the desired account and make sure Check for new messages every is selected. To check new mails as you launch Thunderbird, also tick Check for new messages at startup. Enter the appropriate time interval for auto-checking of mail and click OK.

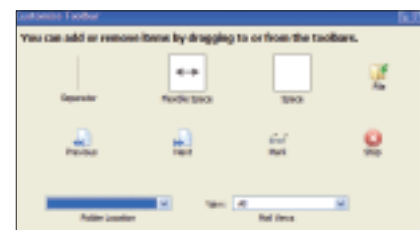
Creating A Mailing List

When working in a group sending mails to everyone using the To and Cc field becomes tedious, creating a mailing list smoothen the process. To create a mailing list in Thunderbird follow the below given steps.

1. From the main menu select Address



Personalising your address book is also convenient



Create easy-to-use e-mailer lists

2. Book and click on the New List icon.
2. Give the mailing list a specific Name, Nick name and Description.
3. Start typing e-mail address of people you want to be that particular list, that done click on OK.
4. Now that you have the list ready, sending an e-mail to the group is very easy. Click on the Write button to compose a new email.
5. In the compose window, click on the Contacts button to launch the contacts sidebar.
6. From the sidebar, the list will be displayed by its name, drag that name in to the To: field and you are done.
7. Compose your mail and send. It will go to everyone present in that list.

Displaying Only Unread Messages

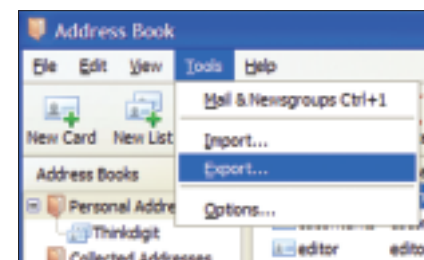
At times, you need to display just the unread messages because we all tend to mark important messages as unread even after reading it so that we can attend to them later. Most of the time we get lost in the sea of read mails.

1. By default, the View Items isn't on the toolbar by default, you need to get it on the toolbar.
2. Go to View>Toolbars>Customise.
3. From the customize page, drag and drop View: drop down menu on to the toolbar.
4. From the drop down, select unread to display all unread messages in your inbox.

Exporting Contacts From Thunderbird

You have been using Thunderbird for long and have accumulated important contact details but now you need to transfer them to a different machine. How do you do that? By exporting data that is common to most email clients. Follow the steps;

1. Click on the Address Book button to launch the Address book and then select the desired book.
2. Select Tools and then click on Export. In the File name field give a



Export contacts at the click of a button

proper name to the address book and in the Save as type field select Comma separated and then click on Save.

3. The Comma Separated file will be saved in the location you choose. This file can be open using excel or can be exported in any other email client.

Adding Background Images To Messages

1. First step is to create a new message in Thunderbird. Click on Write to do so.
2. In the new message window, select Options and click on Format, make sure Auto-Detect is selected.
3. Left-click on the message body to select and then click on Format from the menu in the new message window.
4. Under Format, click on Page Colours and Background and in the subsequent dialog box, click on the Choose File... button.
5. Select the desired file you want to insert as the background, click Open and then click OK.

OUTLOOK 2007

Outlook 2007 is the latest version of popular PIM application from Microsoft and comes bundled with Office 2007. This email client is versatile, powerful and is omni-present on 80 per cent of the desktops running Windows platform. Below are some tips that will enable you to exploit its features in the best possible manner.

Colour Categories

Once you have hundreds of mails in your Inbox, sorting them using regular methods become a pain and that's when Color categories come handy. To set a colour category, click in the blank checkbox next to each mail under the Category column. A default colour will be set to the mail. To change this colour, right-click on a mail, click categories and choose a colour. Select a colour and left-click on all the mails you want to set the colour to.